

NON-BINDING PROPOSAL

XU GROUP DISCOVERY & MVP DEFINITION

Discovery phase for a knowledge, retrieval, and agentic workflow platform direction.

Attention: Thomas Konrad **Email:** t.konrad@xu.de **Date:** 12.05.2026

Dear Thomas, based on our discussion, XU is exploring a new platform direction centered around its knowledge and learning offering. This proposal recommends a short discovery phase to turn that direction into a concrete, buildable MVP plan before architecture, technology, or full implementation budget decisions are fixed.

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1. CONTEXT

XU is exploring a platform direction around aggregating and structuring content and data, then enabling new workflows around search, recommendations, and agent-style interactions. At this stage, the exact scope, priorities, and system shape are still evolving.

The main open questions are which use cases should come first, how the core knowledge layer should be structured, how retrieval and RAG should support those workflows, and how feedback loops should improve the system over time.

2. DISCOVERY GOAL

GOAL

Define a clear path to an MVP and a realistic plan to get it into production.

DISCOVERY WORKSTREAM	WHAT WE CLARIFY	WHY IT MATTERS
Goals, users, and priority use cases	Target users, jobs to be done, success criteria, and first valuable workflows.	Prevents a broad platform idea from turning into an unfocused first build.
Agentic workflow value	Where agents, recommendations, and assisted actions create real user or operational value.	Separates useful automation from novelty.
Knowledge layer and ETL	How XU content, data, and signals are ingested, structured, updated, and governed.	Creates the foundation for reliable retrieval and product growth.
Retrieval, RAG, and feedback loops	How retrieval should work and how usage, outcomes, and corrections improve the system.	Defines the learning loop for quality over time.

3. DISCOVERY OUTPUTS

OUTPUT	DESCRIPTION	OWNERSHIP
Prioritized requirements	A ranked set of concrete requirements translated from the discovery sessions.	XU owns the output and can use it freely, including with other vendors.
MVP definition	A clear first implementation scope, including what the MVP must prove and what remains out of scope.	XU owns the output.
High-level architecture direction	Direction for data, ETL, retrieval, RAG, user-facing flows, and feedback loops.	XU owns the output.
Six-month roadmap	A rough sequence from MVP to production hardening and next-stage product capability.	XU owns the output.
Implementation estimate and proposal	A grounded proposal for delivery after discovery, based on agreed scope, team setup, and delivery approach.	XU owns the output.

4. DELIVERY AFTER DISCOVERY

If the plan is agreed, FORMATION XYZ is available to fully support the project for as long as required.

BUILD SUPPORT

- Bootstrap the project with a small senior team.
- Build a first end-to-end version from data to retrieval to user-facing flow.
- Iterate in short cycles, primarily from within FORMATION XYZ.

OPERATING MODEL

- Maintain weekly check-ins with XU for alignment and progress.
- Choose technologies based on requirements, not prematurely.
- Help XU build internal capability and take over over time.

5. COMMERCIALS

DAY RATE

€1,500 / day / person

Excluding VAT.

INITIAL DISCOVERY

Typically 3-5 days

Final effort depends on participants and workshop format.

IMPLEMENTATION

Refined after discovery

Based on scope, team setup, and delivery approach.

We understand that at this stage XU may be looking for a single number or a cost range for the full project. Given the open questions around scope, requirements, and implementation approach, providing such a figure now would not be useful or fair to either side.

For this reason, we recommend starting with the discovery workshop and needs assessment. This creates a reliable basis for a grounded implementation proposal.

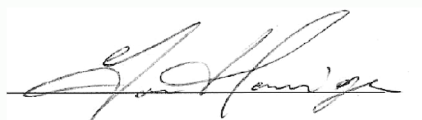
6. NEXT STEP

Align on participants and schedule the discovery sessions.

Recommended start

Discovery workshop and needs assessment with XU stakeholders.

YOURS SINCERELY,



Ian Hannigan

Managing Director

FORMATION GmbH

Berlin, 12.05.2026

